

Enough Of SPIT, Time For It To Quit

First there was regular spam, then cell spam. And now there's SPIT, or Spam over Internet Telephony. Not many companies received SPIT so far, but there's one out there that aims to nip SPIT in the bud. Qovia Inc filed two patent applications for SPIT-thwarting technology.



Navigation Headed For A Whole New Way

Navigation software specialist ALK will allow Windows Mobile-based smartphones to be used as in-car map-readers this September. The software will provide both 2D and 3D maps with spoken directions for navigation while in motion.



Illustrations: Farzana Cooper

Escape

SEARCH FOR EXTRA-TERRESTRIAL INTELLIGENCE

The Day Aliens Came Calling!

Rumours about finding an alien civilisation spread across the Internet on September 1, following a report by New Scientist that an interesting signal had been picked up by SETI@Home's radio telescope in Puerto Rico.

New Scientist quoted Dan Wertheimer, chief scientist at the SETI@Home project, as saying that the signal was the "most interesting" identified thus far. "We're not jumping up and down, but we are continuing to observe it," he remarked.

Now that's just the kind of stuff rumours are made of, and Wertheimer had to tell the BBC the next day, September 2, that the idea of contact with an alien civilisation was all "hype and noise". "We have nothing that is unusual", he said, "It's all out of proportion."

Out of proportion it may have been, but what prompted the initial report that something interesting was picked up? It turns out that the signal was picked up at one of the main absorption frequencies of hydrogen-SETI's favourite

place to look for deliberate signals from other worlds. Scientists at SETI said that the signal had not been observed long enough for it to be properly analysed, and there is plenty of room for explanations. It could be a natural phenomenon, they said, or ground-based interference-or even the possibility that somebody had hacked into the SETI@Home program!

PHISHING

Hijacking is Fun, Jail isn't

Phishers were suspected of having managed the domain-hijacking of the eBay Germany site on August 28. But on September 4, German police arrested a 19-year-old

UNUSABLE!



Bankofindia.com

Ever tried applying for a credit card with Bank of India? Their Web site has a section for card products. However, the only link to download a credit card application form is missing. The bank boasts of being in the credit card business since 1988 and claims to be a pioneer in the field! In the age of virtual money, when 128-bit encryption and similar security measures are giving credit card transactions the long-awaited recognition as a viable online shopping option, this hurdle in the very first step comes across as a major put-off for customers. Talk about unusable!



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Win!

My Desktop

Think you have the most beautiful, most innovative desktop around? Send it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com, and Digit shall publish the most eye-catching of them every month.



The winning entry will win a KUSBDT1/128FE USB stick worth Rs 1,300. This month's winner is Utpal Pande.

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PLANE SILLY: Where 'crashing' takes on a new meaning. Sent by Vaibhav Joshi

responsible for the act.

For several hours, visitors to eBay Germany were redirected to a site hosted by Internet provider Intergeria AG. This caused quite a loss in revenue for the auction giant.

It came as something of a surprise that the 19-year-old is not a computer nerd, as the police confirmed. What he did was to request a DNS transfer for several high-profile sites including Google, Amazon, Web.de and eBay Germany. Most of

